VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

"Data centers in space looking pretty appealing right now"

Elon Musk posted that line at 1:12 a.m. EST Wednesday, after Democrat Gina Hinojosa defeated Gov. Greg Abbott in the Texas governor's race and Democrats won both chambers of Congress, Reuters reported. Hinojosa has called for an immediate halt to new data center projects until lawmakers strengthen protections for local communities, as well as an end to tax breaks. A minute later Musk added: "Guess my election-interfering space lasers didn't work this time."

Musk spent nearly half a billion dollars backing Republican candidates, and Texas is home to Tesla, SpaceX and a planned chipmaking venture between the two, Reuters wrote. According to Wells Fargo, 27% of planned data center gigawatts in the U.S. are in Texas, CNBC reported. SpaceX shares fell 3.8% and Tesla 3.6% in premarket trading Wednesday (Reuters). On Tuesday, Tesla closed down 1.3% at $398.50 and SpaceX up 3.6% at $141.31 (Yahoo Finance).

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

"Starlink grows customers for airlines"

Musk pointed to a Japanese budget airline's Starlink results, Air Tahiti Nui signed up its whole fleet, and Starlink Mobile picked Qualcomm for its 5G base stations.

+12.3%	2027	25–30 ms
ZIPAIR passenger revenue, April to September	start of Air Tahiti Nui's Starlink rollout and Starlink Mobile's cell sites	latency Air Tahiti Nui expects from Starlink

"Starlink grows customers for airlines," Musk wrote at 11:10 a.m. EST Tuesday, quoting a post about ZIPAIR, the low-cost arm of Japan Airlines. "The enhancement of product value through the completed installation of 'Starlink', high-speed internet service across all aircraft, and flexible pricing strategies responding to the market, led to a 12.3% increase in passenger revenue year-on-year," JAL said in its first-half results on Monday. The airline group's revenue for the half rose 11.7% to ¥1,098.9 billion, a record since its re-listing.

Air Tahiti Nui and SpaceX "have signed an agreement to equip our entire Boeing 787-9 fleet with Starlink Wi-Fi," the airline announced from Papeete on Tuesday. Wi-Fi will be free in all travel classes, with a rollout expected in 2027. Starlink posted that passengers and crew will be connected "from gate to gate."

ON THE WIRE

Premarket. SpaceX shares fell 3.8% and Tesla 3.6% before Wednesday's open as both lagged the broader market (Reuters).

Starlink Mobile picks Qualcomm

"Starlink Mobile is building the first fully-integrated US nationwide satellite and terrestrial network that will keep people connected on their phones no matter where they are," Starlink posted at 8:32 a.m. EST Wednesday. Its 5G base stations will use Qualcomm's Dragonwing hardware and software across tens of thousands of new cell sites, with rollout starting next year, CNBC reported. Qualcomm called it its largest 5G initiative to date; financial terms were not disclosed.

ON THE WIRE

Texas share. Wells Fargo counts 27% of planned U.S. data center gigawatts in Texas (CNBC).



A string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky over the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.
PHOTO: DKTUE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0 (CROPPED)

"Electrical equipment, cooling, networking and batteries"

Musk added those words at 11:07 a.m. EST Tuesday to a post summarizing his view that chip output is outrunning electricity supply outside China, so that "by the end of the year, we will be making more AI chips than we can actually turn on." In his words, the post said, "the bottleneck for the next year is not chips, it is raw power."

II · X, GROK & AI

"Like hiring a super competent employee"

Musk spent Tuesday showing what Grok Bot can do: phone calls, doctor's appointments, family trips and shopping.

"Grok @Bot is like hiring a super competent employee. Treat Bot like you would a colleague," Musk wrote at 11:11 a.m. EST Tuesday, quoting investor Peter Diamandis, who posted: "GrokBot is AWESOME. Actually addicting." Earlier, at 9:34 a.m., he answered "Yes" (post) to a thread arguing that people should give the agent ambitious tasks rather than just questions.

Calls, doctors and trips

"Grok @Bot can research which doctors are the best in your area, call them by phone and make an appointment!" Musk posted at 12:11 p.m. EST, quoting a user whose agent called a pediatric orthopedist after his daughter hurt her foot at dance practice and "got her in at 9:30 the same day."

Five minutes earlier he wrote "Grok @Bot can do complex trips," quoting a user who booked flights for a family trip and said: "I'll likely never use an airline's website again." At 3:56 p.m. he posted "Try asking Grok @Bot to make calls!" The calling feature shows a live transcript, and when the agent needs more information, a box pops up for the user's answer, which it relays to the person on the phone, according to the post he quoted.

"Shopping is great"

"Grok @Bot shopping is great," Musk wrote at 3:16 a.m. EST Wednesday, quoting the @bot account's post: "Try the new shopping experience in Grok Bot. Find the best deal, compare items, and have Bot track all your orders."

QUICK HIT

Out of beta in the car. Tesla software update 2026.38.6, now in wide release, removes the "Beta" label from the Grok interface on vehicle screens and adds Latvian to the on-screen menus, Tesla Oracle reported.

III · TESLA

German registrations nearly quadruple

Tesla's October numbers jumped in Germany, the Dutch regulator signed off on a slower, renamed driver-assistance system, the Megapack plant won a tariff break, and Tesla showed the new Roadster from the inside.

Tesla registered 2,932 new cars in Germany in October, up 290.9% from a year earlier, the KBA motor transport authority said, Reuters reported. From January to October Tesla registered 47,742 cars, up 206.1%. Battery-electric cars made up 37.0% of all new registrations in October, and Tesla's share of the market was 1.2%, against 2.0% for BYD.

Assisted Driving, capped at +10%

The Dutch vehicle authority RDW approved changes to Tesla's system on Tuesday: FSD Supervised is now called Tesla Assisted Driving in Europe, and the maximum speed margin drops from +50% to +10% and resets to 0% at each start. The update applies to cars with HW4 or newer and arrives over the air. A Europe-wide vote has been pushed to December at the earliest, Electrek reported.

Megapack plant gets a foreign-trade zone

Tesla's Megapack factory in Brookshire, Texas, has been authorized to operate as a foreign-trade subzone on a limited basis for 14 months, according to a Federal Register notice published Monday. Tesla filed on May 20, listing about 80 imported parts with duties of up to 6.5%, while finished Megapacks and Bento inverters carry duties from zero to 3.4%. Parts covered by Section 301, 232 and 122 tariffs still pay them, Electrek reported; duties are deferred and none are owed on direct exports. The plant can build 50 GWh a year.



The Roadster prototype at its launch event in November 2017.
PHOTO: SMNT / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0 (CROPPED)

"POV you're a flying car"

Tesla posted a point-of-view clip at 11:47 a.m. EST Tuesday from the next-generation Roadster's Oct. 15 unveiling at SpaceX's McGregor, Texas, test site. The uncrewed prototype fires cold-gas thrusters and rolls fully inverted over a Model 3, Model Y, Cybercab, Cybertruck and Semi; all runs were autonomous, Teslarati reported. Musk has indicated production is targeted for 2028.

ON THE WIRE

Year to date. Tesla registered 47,742 new cars in Germany from January to October, up 206.1% (Reuters).

IV · LIFE & IDEAS

$2,500 and a ticket to Montreal

Musk corrected the figure in a retelling of his arrival in Canada and shared a clip on what drives him.

"Actually, I had ~$2500, which was the amount left over after buying a ticket to Montreal from South Africa," Musk replied at 11:13 a.m. EST Tuesday. The post he answered said that in 1989 a 17-year-old Musk landed in Montreal with about $4,000, stayed in a youth hostel with five strangers, and after a week bought a $100 Greyhound pass to cross Canada to a cousin's farm in Saskatchewan.

"Quest to understand the Universe"

Musk posted the phrase at 12:03 p.m. EST Tuesday over an interview clip in which he said: "I really want to make sure that there is a good future for humanity, and that we're on a path to understanding the nature of the universe, the meaning of life. Why are we here? How do we get here?" In the clip he added: "I'm motivated by curiosity more than anything, and just a desire to think about the future and not be sad."

QUICK HIT

On envy. "Greed can be satisfied. Envy, cannot," investor Naval Ravikant wrote. Musk replied "True" at 2:55 a.m. EST Wednesday. On Tuesday he called a J.R.R. Tolkien passage shared by @AlcuinPress "Prophetic" (post).

Takeaways

1. After the Texas governor's race, Musk said data centers in space look "pretty appealing."
2. Hinojosa has called for an immediate halt to new data center projects in Texas.
3. JAL credited Starlink on every ZIPAIR plane for a 12.3% rise in passenger revenue.
4. Air Tahiti Nui will put free Starlink Wi-Fi on all its 787-9s from 2027.
5. Starlink Mobile chose Qualcomm for its 5G base stations, starting next year.
6. Musk pitched Grok Bot for calls, appointments, trips and shopping.
7. Tesla's German registrations rose 290.9% in October, and the RDW capped Assisted Driving's speed margin at +10%.
8. Tesla's Brookshire Megapack plant can now defer duties on imported parts in a foreign-trade zone.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @Starlink, @Tesla, @bot, @cb_doge, @euwyn, @PeterDiamandis, @TheCaptainEli, @minchoi, @pud, @SawyerMerritt, @EvaFox, @XFreeze, @naval and @AlcuinPress.

Reuters · CNBC · JAL · RDW · Electrek · Federal Register · Teslarati · Air Tahiti Nui · Tesla Oracle · Yahoo Finance. Photos: Dktue and Smnt via Wikimedia Commons (credits with photos).

BY THE NUMBERS

12.3%	ZIPAIR passenger revenue growth, April to September (JAL)
25–30 ms	Starlink latency Air Tahiti Nui expects (Air Tahiti Nui)
$398.50	Tesla's Tuesday close, down 1.3% (Yahoo Finance)
50 GWh	Brookshire Megapack plant's yearly capacity (Electrek)
290.9%	Rise in Tesla's German registrations in October (Reuters)

The Elon Gazette is compiled from public posts on X and published reporting. Quotes are reproduced verbatim unless marked as translated or paraphrased.